

C3. Social Media: types, history, evolution and consumer trends



SOCIAL MEDIA



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SI COMUNICARE



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Types of social media [SM] platforms

- There are plenty of online articles discussing various types of social media
- There are different types of social media services that cater to different needs and adapt to different types of content.
- While some have overlapping features, others are more specific in terms of use and type of services offered.
- SM content ranges across text posts, images, videos, comments and networking platforms.
- Their classification should be based on use and content, but many classifications are geared towards their marketing and advertising potential.



Types of social media [SM] platforms

We can distinguish the following categories based on content:

- Social networks
- News platforms and discussion forums
- Image sharing networks
- Video streaming and sharing platforms
- Social audio platforms
- Bookmarking networks
- Blogging and publishing networks
- Micro-blogging networks
- Consumer review networks
- Interest-based networks
- Social shopping networks
- Sharing economy networks (exchange of goods and services)





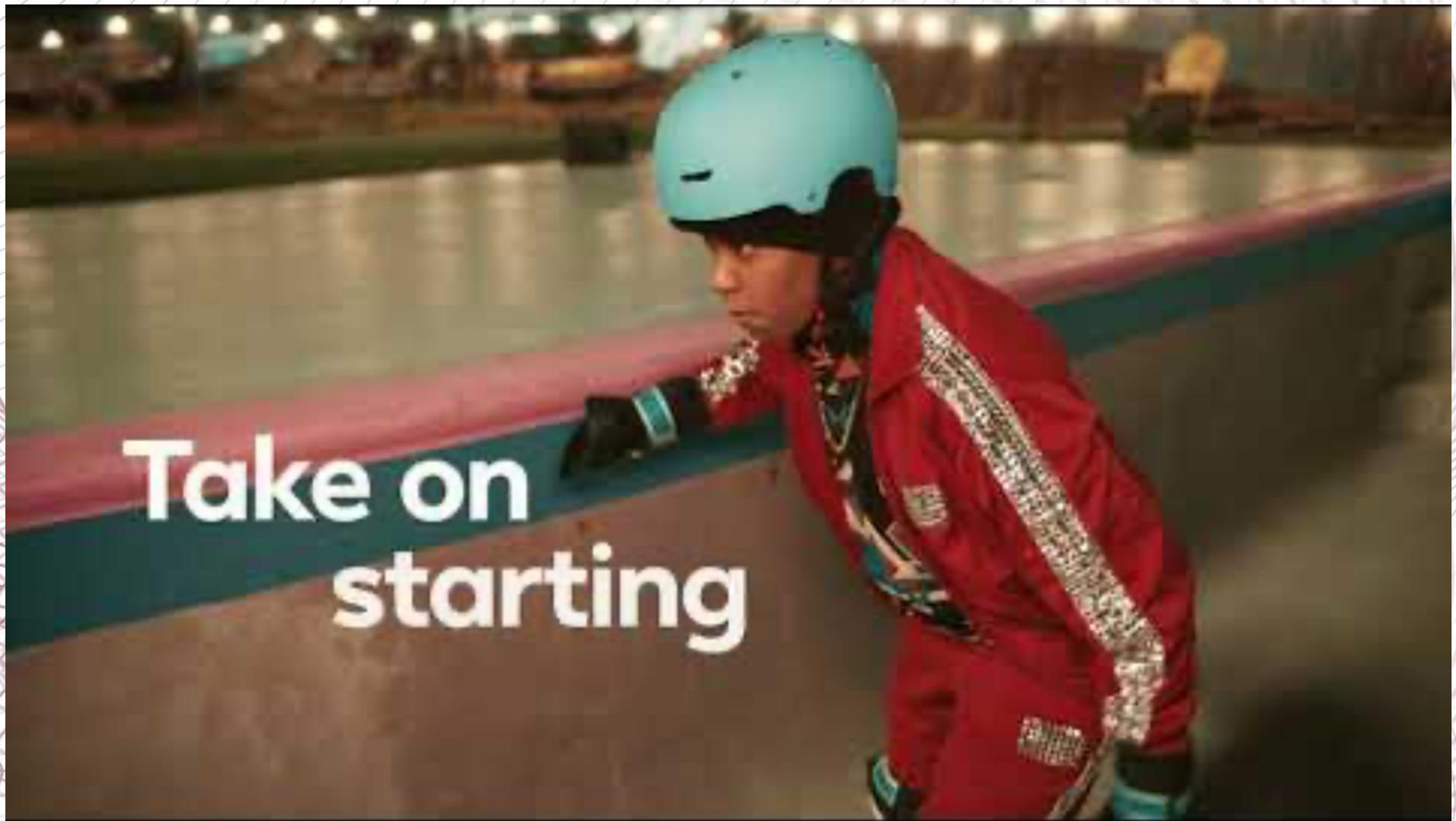
Social networks

Social networking sites allow users to connect and share information with other users like themselves.

Social networks help build virtual communities for people with similar attitudes, interests, education, opinions and lifestyles

→ principles of association

e.g. Facebook
Instagram, TikTok, X, LinkedIn



<https://www.youtube.com/@facebookapp/videos>



<https://www.youtube.com/@facebookapp/videos>



Regency Finds

2,1 mil. de vizionări • acum 3 săptămâni



For Every Listing, There's A Story - Regency Riders

2,2 K de vizionări • acum 3 săptămâni



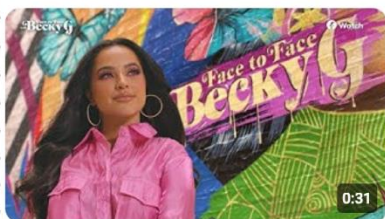
Regency Finds

3,5 mil. de vizionări • acum 1 lună



For Every Listing, There's A Story - Your Chariot A-Skates

3,5 K de vizionări • acum 1 lună



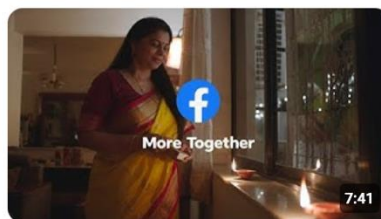
Face to Face With Becky G—Official Trailer | Facebook Watch

736 K de vizionări • acum 4 ani



Facebook: More Together - "Rajani"

308 K de vizionări • acum 4 ani



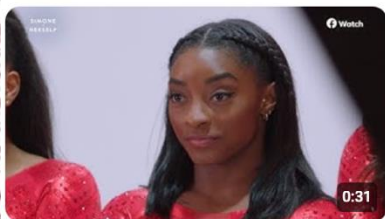
Facebook: More Together - Rajani

21 mil. de vizionări • acum 4 ani



Facebook: More Together - Cricket

14 mil. de vizionări • acum 4 ani



Simone vs Herself Returns | Official Teaser | Facebook Watch

36 K de vizionări • acum 4 ani



Facebook Watch: Ice Lolly

2,9 mil. de vizionări • acum 4 ani



Facebook Watch: Fan

2,9 mil. de vizionări • acum 4 ani



Becky G Takes on Anything with Facebook Groups

74 K de vizionări • acum 4 ani





<https://www.youtube.com/@LinkedIn>



<https://www.youtube.com/@LinkedIn>



2026 Labor Market Report: Building a Future of Work That Works

1,6 K de vizionări • acum 2 luni



Open to Work: How to Get Ahead in the Age of AI | Ryan Roslansky & Aneesh Raman

732 de vizionări • acum 2 luni



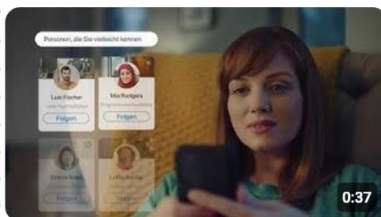
Understanding Ad Technology on LinkedIn

6,3 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Was sind die Vorteile der LinkedIn App? Mit der App hast du die ganze Arbeitswelt in...

3,8 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



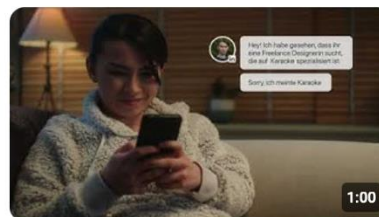
Wie kannst du mit LinkedIn immer top-informiert bleiben? Wir erklären, wie es geht.

14 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



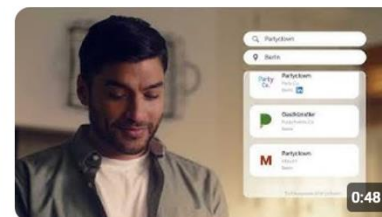
Welche Inhalte und Formate kannst du auf LinkedIn teilen? Wir erklären, wie das geht.

16 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Wie kannst du auf LinkedIn dein berufliches Netzwerk aufbauen? Wir erklären, wie es...

23 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Wie geht Jobsuche und Bewerbung auf LinkedIn? Hier erklären wir, wie es geht.

21 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



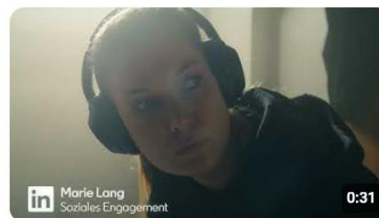
Ein LinkedIn Profil erstellen oder aktualisieren? Wir erklären, wie es geht.

15 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



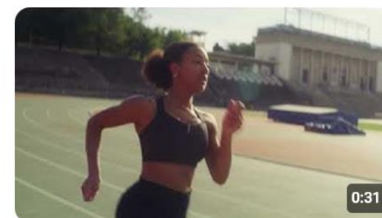
O início da sua carreira começa aqui: LinkedIn para estudantes.

2,5 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Zeig, was du kannst: Füge Kenntnisse & Fähigkeiten in deinem LinkedIn Profil hinzu

1,7 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Mostra la tue competenze: Aggiungi conoscenze e competenze al tuo profilo...

1,5 K de vizionări • acum 1 an

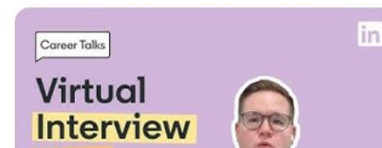
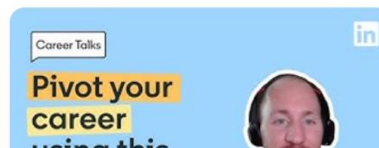


Image sharing networks

These platforms allow users to distribute images & short videos

Most of them provide interactive features. Users can create profiles and comment the posted media..

it is no longer about "social" activities in the purest sense, but about practical activities, especially those based on content consumption - GlobalWebIndex report (2019)

→ principles of organisation

E.g. Instagram, Flickr, Photobucket



News platforms and discussion forums



These platforms allow users to post links to news and other information that is contained in the news/topics.

The main feature is the voting of posts/topics, and those that get more votes are being highlighted and given a higher rank.

Simplifies the search and allows users to distribute bookmarks to their "followers".

→ principles of organisation and participation

E.g. Reddit, Quora, Digg, Clubhouse



<https://www.youtube.com/@reddit/videos>



<https://www.youtube.com/@reddit/videos>



Ask Me (Almost) Anything: Q1 2025 Earnings Call

6,5 K de vizionări • acum 10 luni



Ask Me (Almost) Anything: Q4 2024 Earnings Call

3,4 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



This story has been 16 years in the making...

16 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Ask Me (Almost) Anything: Q3 2024 Earnings Call

3,4 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



r/OutOfTheLoop: Celebrity Number Six

1,9 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Ask Me (Almost) Anything: Q2 2024 Earnings Call

3,6 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Where's autocorrect when you need it? #spellingfail

1,6 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



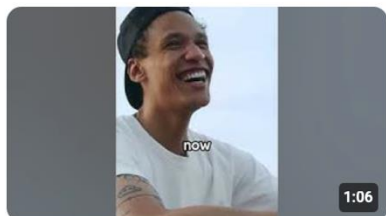
Huge congrats to u/kimmipea on this major life update. #britishsuccess

1,2 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Their lives would be different without kindness. 🥰 Watch Beverly Hills Cop: Axel...

1,1 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



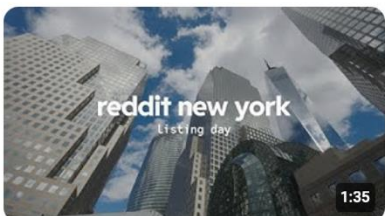
15 years of r/relationship_advice has given us highs *and* lows. #relationshipadvice

2,4 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Reddit Goes Public | Recap

4,8 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Snoo gets ready for Reddit's IPO

3,9 K de vizionări • acum 1 an



Video streaming and sharing platforms

These platforms allow users to distribute and stream videos of various durations.

most of them have interactive features. Users can create profiles and comment on uploaded content.

it is no longer about "social" activities in the purest sense, but about practical activities, especially those based on content consumption - GlobalWebIndex report (2019)

→ principles of organization & content management

E.g. YouTube, TikTok, Snapchat, Vimeo, Twitch



Social audio platforms



- These social media platforms use audio recording as their primary means of communication. It can include text messaging, podcasts, audio recording and editing tools, and virtual audio rooms.
 - They are recent and evolving
 - 2020: launch of Clubhouse
 - developers are still trying to figure out what works for their users and what doesn't
- principles of organization & content management
- E.g., Clubhouse, Telegram Voice Chats, Facebook Live Audio Rooms and Podcasts, Discord Stages, Spotify Greenroom, Twitter Spaces



- <https://www.youtube.com/@Spotify/videos>

Bookmarking sites/networks



These platforms allow users to save and organise their ideas, articles, posts, and other content for later use. Many people also share links to lists of online resources.

The main feature is labelling. The purpose of these sites is to discover new content based on shared interests and discuss trends

Simplifies the search and allows users to distribute bookmarks to their followers.

→ principles of organization

E.g. Pinterest, Mix (former StumbleUpon), Flipboard, Feedly, Pocket

Blogging and publishing networks



Stay curious.

Discover stories, thinking, and expertise from writers on any topic.

These platforms provide a place for users to post their thoughts about work, current events, hobbies and more. They enjoy many of the benefits of their own blog without having to host it on their own website

The main feature is content creation. The purpose of these sites is to allow content to be published based on common interests.

→ principles of organization

E.g. Medium, WordPress, Facebook, Tumblr

Microblogging

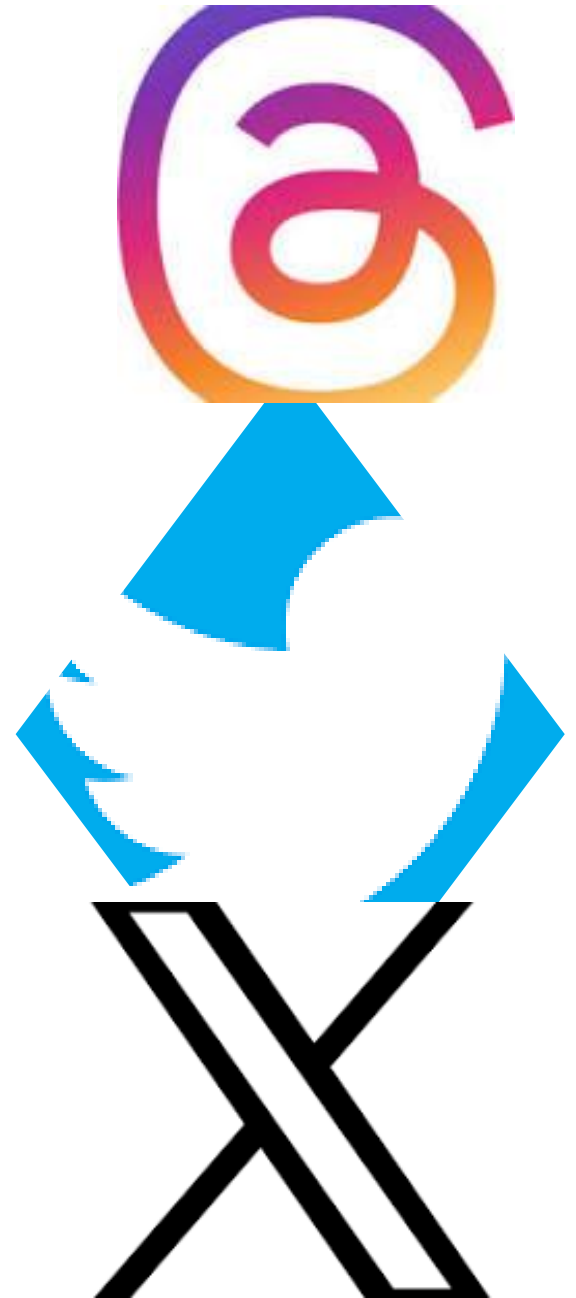
These platforms allow users to upload short descriptions (text) that may include links to various websites or other social media platforms

These posts are available on the "wall" of all subscribers/followers

Simplifies search and allows users to distribute bookmarks to their followers as well principles of participation

→ principles of participation

E.g. X, Threads



Consumer review networks

They provide a space for users where they can review products or services they have used.

→ principles of ranking

E.g. Yelp, Zomato, TripAdvisor, OpenTable



Interest-based networks



Are social networks that support people to share and distribute their hobbies and interests with other people (Social networks according to common interests)

→ principles of association

E.g., Goodreads, Strava, Peanut

Social shopping networks

- Such networks help users identify trends, share great finds, make purchases and follow their favourite brands. They focus on e-commerce, and the social element makes these networks engaging and fun.
- Many social networks now include social shopping elements.
→ marketplace principles
- E.g., Instagram, Poshmark, Etsy, Facebook



Sharing economy networks (exchange of goods and services)

- allows people to share resources such as equipment, services and skills with each other, often at a significantly lower cost than traditional retail or contract work.
- Anybody can participate and is allowed to get by without owning valuables such as cars, houses, tools and money, while creating opportunities for others to extract value from unused possessions or talents.

→ principles of reciprocity

- E.g., Lending Club, Couchsurfing, Eatwith



Other Classiffications

- See: <https://blog.hootsuite.com/types-of-social-media/>



[Log In](#)[Start your free trial](#)

Strategy

7 Types of Social Media and How Each Can Benefit Your Business

Find out how you can use different types of social media platforms and formats to support your business (and social) goals.

Sarah Israel
November 8, 2023
🕒 7 min read

Also available in  



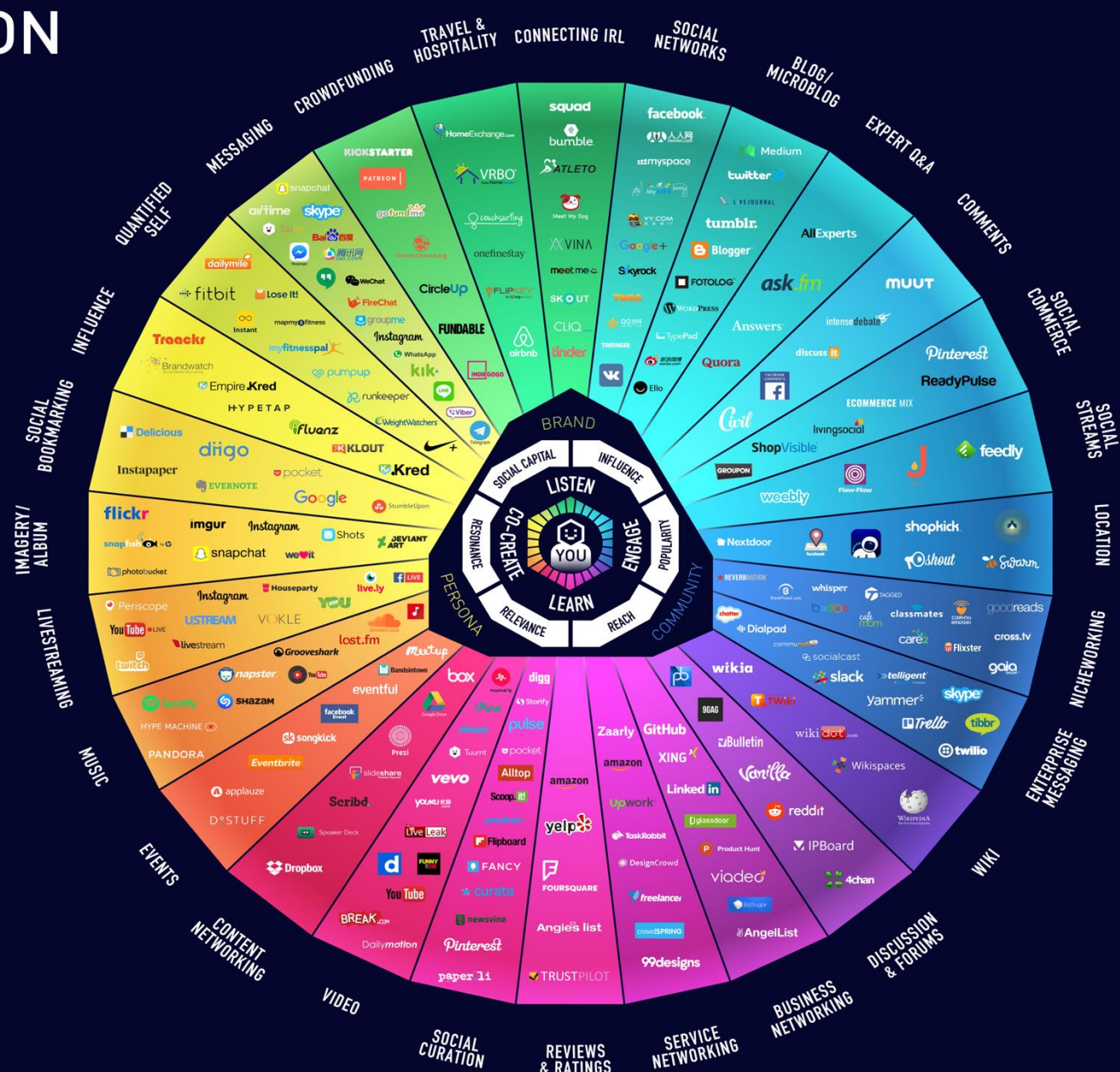
Brought to you by
Brian Solis & JESS3

Social Media Gave Everyone a Voice

The Conversation Prism debuted in 2008 as social media was exploding online. Social media would change everything about how we communicate, learn and share. It forever democratized information and reset the balance for influence.

The Conversation Prism was designed as a visual map of the conversational networks that continue to reshape everything. Its purpose is to help you understand and appreciate the statusphere so that you can play a productive and defining role in the conversations shaping our future.

For more information check out **conversationprism.com**



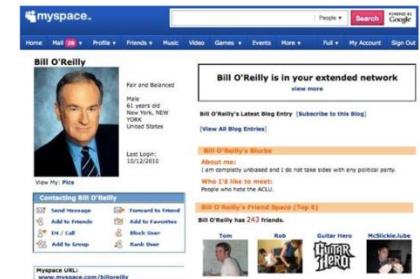
Categorii Social Media. Prisma conversației 5.0 realizată de Brian Solis, disponibilă la adresa: www.conversationprism.com, accesată în 10.09.2021



History and evolution of social media platforms

Brief history

- 1997: 6 degrees
- 1998 Tencent, QQ
- 2002: Friendster
- 2003 myspace
- 2003 hi5
- 2003 LinkedIn
- 2003 Photobucket
- 2003 Delicious
- 2004 Flickr
- 2004 Facebook
- 2005 Youtube
- 2005 Bebo
- 2005 reddit
- 2006 Twitter
- 2007 Tumblr
- 2009 WhatsApp
- 2009 foursquare
- 2009 vevo
- 2010 Instagram
- 2010 Pinterest
- 2010 wechat
- 2011 Google +
- 2011 Snapchat
- 2011 Twitch
- 2012 Vine
- 2012 Tinder
- 2013 Telegram
- 2014 musical.ly
- 2015 Discord
- 2017 TikTok
- 2023 Threads

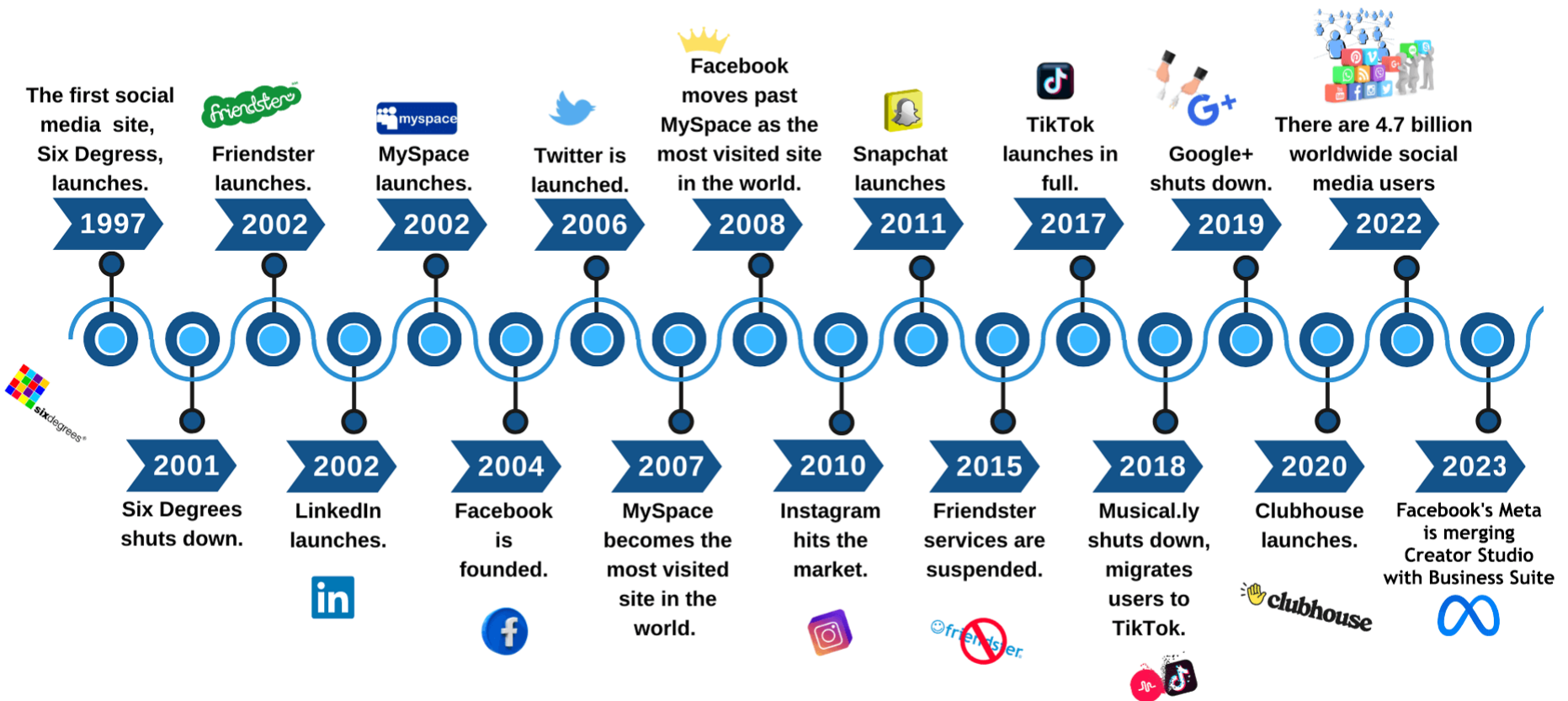


: https://youtu.be/gAEExRJF_Vw?si=Y-jkGdXLSwztMZJo ,

accessed 11.02. 2026

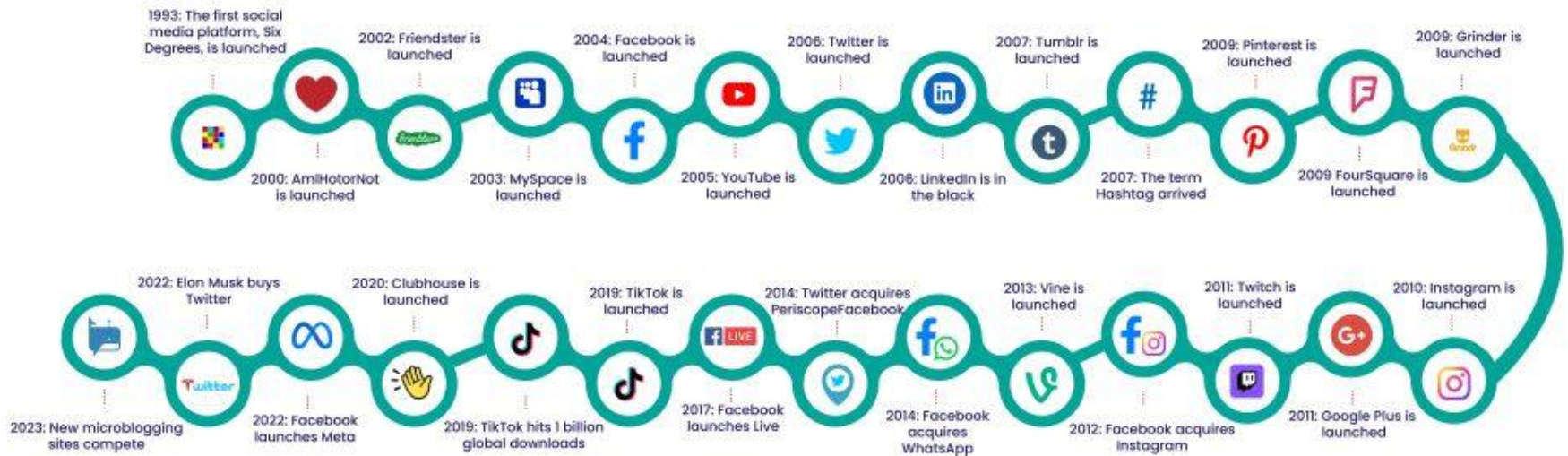


Social Media Timeline



For a more detailed description of the history and forerunners of social media, see: https://youtu.be/Cz_kopcg9rc (accessed 4.03. 2026)

SOCIAL MEDIA TIMELINE



Social Media Tulsa